



"Full Marx",
December 24, 2007

"It is a paradox that a party, which holds a mere 6 per cent of the country's vote, enjoys a clout beyond its worth and is able to hold the nation to ransom."

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, *Pune*

The Red Bogeyman

The magazine deserves full marks for its cover story on Prakash Karat ("Full Marx", December 24). It has provoked him brilliantly enough to make him deny that he ever made a threat of mid-term polls on the issue of the Indo-US nuclear deal.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,
Thiruvananthapuram

One should not take Karat and his threats seriously. The drama is being played out to impress CPI(M) voters in West Bengal and Kerala.

A. SRIKANTIAH, *Bangalore*

It is unfortunate that a negative man like Karat had to be accredited with the title of the Newsmaker this year. His double standards are betrayed by the fact that his party is supporting the UPA regime even as he is contemplating the formation of a third front.

BAL GOVIND, *Bareilly*

Karat is a frog in the well who is interested in following his party's manifesto in toto, unmindful of the circumstances around him.

V.K. NAIR, *Mumbai*

Why has the CPI(M) general secretary been given full marks? For stalling the UPA Government? Had the Left allowed the Centre and the prime minister to function freely, the Government would have delivered much better results. Handicapped by the bullying tactics of the coalition partner, the Government has been running on one cylinder.

MADHU R.D. SINGH, *Ambala*

It would be better if the magazine featured some unsung social reformers, instead of good-for-nothing characters like Karat, on its cover.

SUNDAR RAJAN, *on e-mail*

Karat's selection as the newsmaker of the year 2007 is amusing. He made

the maximum noise and the magazine heard it. So, he gets full marks. It is hoped that his levels of patriotism had been evaluated as well.

G. EDWARD DAVID,
Bangalore

Karat has to be respected for his candour towards the Marxist ideology, howsoever harmful it may be to the country.

VIJAY DANDIWALA, *on e-mail*

If Karat is rabidly anti-American, the magazine is anti-communist and never the twain shall meet. Karat has been objecting to the nuke deal on several grounds, not just because he is against the US. Moreover, this decision has been taken by the politburo and not by an individual. Nowhere have his arguments been rebutted. Only his anti-American stance has been given precedence.

S.S. RAJAGOPALAN, *Chennai*

If individuals and peripheral parties can tease and tantalise governments like this, we must think afresh.

KARAN KHARB, *Noida*

The Return of the King

BJP's hollow claims of being an ideology-based party and condemnation of Congress for encouraging personality cult were exposed when it nominated 80-year-old L.K. Advani as its prime minister-in-waiting ("Candidate Advani", December 24).

MADHU AGRAWAL, *Delhi*

Advani's crowning as BJP's prime ministerial candidate is a clear acceptance of the fact that the party has no young leader who can be acceptable to all. BJP leadership needs to fast introduce fresh blood in its ranks.

J.S. ACHARYA, *Hyderabad*

Down with the Dictator

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Mayawati should understand the difference